

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET A — FOUNDATION & CORE CONCEPTS****CHAPTER 07: ELECTIONS**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-A-07

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET A - Foundation & Core Concepts):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
3. Each question offers four options: **(A), (B), (C), and (D)**. Select the single best answer.
4. Darken the corresponding circle on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

Q.1 Why are periodic elections essential in a large representative democracy?

- (A) To allow citizens to choose their lawmakers, form the government, and periodically hold leaders accountable
- (B) To waste national economic resources unnecessarily
- (C) Because kings require public entertainment every five years
- (D) To permanently prevent any changes in national policies

Q.2 For the purpose of Lok Sabha elections, the entire territory of India is demarcated into how many single-member territorial constituencies?

- (A) 543
- (B) 250
- (C) 412
- (D) 590

Q.3 The representative elected by voters from a state legislative assembly constituency is called a:

- (A) Member of Legislative Assembly (MLA)
- (B) Member of Parliament (MP)
- (C) Municipal Commissioner
- (D) Governor

Q.4 Why does the Indian Constitution provide for 'Reserved Constituencies' in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies?

- (A) To ensure fair representation for historically weaker and disadvantaged sections (Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes)
- (B) To reserve seats exclusively for royal families and nobility
- (C) To guarantee that only billionaires can enter Parliament
- (D) To prevent rural citizens from voting

Q.5 What proportion of seats is constitutionally reserved for women in local self-government institutions (Panchayats and Municipalities) in India?

- (A) One-third (33%)
- (B) One-tenth (10%)
- (C) Fifty percent exactly in all states
- (D) No seats are reserved

Q.6 The official list of citizens entitled to vote in an election, officially prepared and updated by the Election Commission, is called the Electoral Roll or:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| (A) Voters' List | (B) Census Register |
| (C) Tax Assessment Roll | (D) Gazette of Citizens |

Q.7 In India, what is the minimum qualifying age for a citizen to register as a voter in general elections?

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| (A) 18 years | (B) 21 years |
| (C) 25 years | (D) 16 years |

Q.8 What is the minimum age requirement for an Indian citizen to contest an election for the Lok Sabha or State Legislative Assembly?

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| (A) 25 years | (B) 18 years |
| (C) 30 years | (D) 35 years |

Q.9 Under recent election reforms directed by the Supreme Court, what mandatory declaration must every candidate submit in an affidavit along with nomination papers?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Details of criminal cases pending, assets and liabilities of candidate and family, and educational qualifications | (B) Their favourite cricket team and movie preferences |
| (C) A pledge never to resign from political office | (D) Proof of ownership of an overseas bank account |

Q.10 What was the famous political campaign slogan given by Indira Gandhi in the 1971 Lok Sabha elections?

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---|
| (A) Garibi Hatao (Remove Poverty) | (B) Save Democracy |
| (C) Land to the Tiller | (D) Protect Self-Respect of the Telugus |

Q.11 The slogan 'Save Democracy' was adopted in the 1977 Lok Sabha elections by which political coalition led by Jayaprakash Narayan?

- | | |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|
| (A) Janata Party | (B) Congress Party |
| (C) Communist Party | (D) Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam |

Q.12 According to Indian election law, which of the following practices is an election offense and strictly prohibited during campaigning?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Bribing or threatening voters, appealing to caste or religion, and using government vehicles for electioneering | (B) Distributing printed manifestos and organizing public speeches |
| (C) Conducting door-to-door meetings with residents | (D) Setting up election campaign offices within permissible guidelines |

Q.13 What is the maximum expenditure limit permitted by law for a candidate contesting a Lok Sabha constituency in major Indian states (as revised recently)?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| (A) Up to ₹95 Lakhs | (B) Up to ₹10 Lakhs |
| (C) Unlimited expenditure permitted | (D) Up to ₹1 Crore each day |

Q.14 The set of ethical norms and guidelines agreed upon by all political parties to regulate conduct during election campaigns is known as the:

- | | |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| (A) Model Code of Conduct (MCC) | (B) Constitution Preamble |
| (C) Criminal Procedure Code | (D) Parliamentary Privileges Charter |

Q.15 According to the Model Code of Conduct, once elections are formally announced by the Election Commission, government ministers cannot:

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Lay foundation stones for new projects, announce major financial grants, or make policy promises | (B) Eat food in public restaurants |
| (C) Meet their family members | (D) Travel outside their home district |

Q.16 Which autonomous constitutional body is entrusted with conducting free, fair, and impartial elections to the Parliament and State Legislatures in India?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Election Commission of India (ECI) | (B) Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) |
| (C) Planning Commission / NITI Aayog | (D) Law Commission of India |

Q.17 How is the independence of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) of India constitutionally safeguarded?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) The CEC is appointed by the President but cannot be removed from office by the executive, except through a rigorous parliamentary impeachment-like procedure | (B) The CEC is an elected representative of the ruling party |
| (C) The CEC serves at the day-to-day pleasure of the Prime Minister | (D) The CEC's decisions are routinely overridden by police chiefs |

Q.18 During election duty, which authority exercises direct administrative control over government civil servants and police personnel?

- | | |
|--|--------------------------------------|
| (A) The Election Commission of India (ECI) | (B) The Chief Minister of the State |
| (C) The Ministry of Home Affairs | (D) Local political party presidents |

Q.19 What electronic device is utilized across all polling booths in India to record and count votes securely?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| (A) Electronic Voting Machine (EVM) | (B) Automated Teller Machine (ATM) |
| (C) Barcode Scanning Cash Register | (D) Internet Voting Mobile App |

Q.20 What verification mechanism attached to an EVM prints a paper slip displaying the candidate's name and symbol for 7 seconds so the voter can verify their vote?

- | | |
|--|----------------------------------|
| (A) Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) | (B) Aadhaar Biometric Punch Card |
| (C) Optical Character Recognition Scanner | (D) Magnetic Strip Reader |

Q.21 What measure is taken by election polling officials on voting day to prevent any citizen from casting multiple fraudulent votes?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) Marking the voter's left index finger with indelible silver nitrate ink | (B) Taking a physical DNA sample |
| (C) Holding the voter's mobile phone as collateral for a week | (D) Requiring the voter to run a marathon |

Q.22 The percentage of eligible voters who actually cast their ballots on polling day is technically referred to as the:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-----------------------|
| (A) Voter Turnout | (B) Electoral Quorum |
| (C) Constituency Majority | (D) Margin of Victory |

Q.23 In India, unlike in many Western democracies where wealthy and educated citizens vote in higher percentages, who participates in elections in very large numbers?

- | | |
|---|-------------------------------|
| (A) Poor, illiterate, and underprivileged communities | (B) Only corporate executives |
| (C) Only foreign tourists | (D) Only senior bureaucrats |

Q.24 What is the 'NOTA' option provided at the end of the candidate list on an Indian EVM?

- (A) None of the Above (allowing voters to reject all contesting candidates) (B) National Opposition Tariff Agency
(C) Nominate Only Trained Advocates (D) Non-Official Tactical Agreement

Q.25 Which of the following remains a significant challenge to the fairness of Indian elections that electoral reforms seek to address?

- (A) Excessive influence of money power, criminal candidates, and dynasty politics (B) Citizens being too eager to vote
(C) Total absence of political parties (D) Lack of ballot paper printing presses

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET A)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET A)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.1	(A)	Elections provide a peaceful mechanism for citizens to select their representatives, endorse policies, and replace non-performing leaders.
Q.2	(A)	India is divided into 543 Lok Sabha constituencies, each electing one Member of Parliament (MP) to the lower house.
Q.3	(A)	Voters in state assembly constituencies elect a Member of Legislative Assembly (MLA) to represent them in the Vidhan Sabha.
Q.4	(A)	Reserved constituencies ensure that SC and ST communities, who might otherwise lack financial or social resources to win against elites, have voice in legislatures.
Q.5	(A)	Under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments, not less than one-third (33%) of all seats and chairperson positions are reserved for women in local bodies.
Q.6	(A)	The Electoral Roll, commonly known as the Voters' List, is the official register of eligible voters prepared ahead of elections.
Q.7	(A)	The 61st Constitutional Amendment Act (1988) reduced the voting age from 21 years to 18 years for all Indian citizens.
Q.8	(A)	To contest Lok Sabha or Vidhan Sabha elections, a candidate must be an Indian citizen of at least 25 years of age.
Q.9	(A)	Candidates must disclose criminal antecedents, assets/liabilities, and education in sworn affidavits so voters can make informed choices.
Q.10	(A)	The Congress led by Indira Gandhi swept the 1971 elections with the iconic rallying slogan 'Garibi Hatao' (Remove Poverty).
Q.11	(A)	The Janata Party under Jayaprakash Narayan fought the post-Emergency 1977 elections on the banner of 'Save Democracy'.
Q.12	(A)	The Representation of the People Act prohibits bribery, religious/caste appeals, use of places of worship, and misuse of government resources.
Q.13	(A)	The spending ceiling for a Lok Sabha parliamentary constituency was enhanced to ₹95 lakhs (in larger states) to check corrupt money power.
Q.14	(A)	The Model Code of Conduct (MCC) comes into force immediately upon election announcement, barring ministers from laying foundation stones or using state machinery.
Q.15	(A)	Ministers cannot announce new welfare schemes or foundation stones to unfairly influence voters once the election schedule is gazetted.
Q.16	(A)	Article 324 of the Indian Constitution vests the superintendence, direction, and control of elections in the independent Election Commission of India.
Q.17	(A)	The CEC enjoys security of tenure like a Supreme Court judge and cannot be arbitrarily dismissed by the government.
Q.18	(A)	During the election period, government officers and police work under the deputation and disciplinary control of the Election Commission, not the state government.
Q.19	(A)	Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) record votes securely and prevent booth capturing and fraudulent ballot stuffing.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.20	(A)	VVPAT generates an instant paper slip visible behind glass for 7 seconds, providing an independent physical audit trail to verify EVM integrity.
Q.21	(A)	Indelible ink containing silver nitrate is applied to the voter's finger, leaving a stain that cannot be washed off for several weeks.
Q.22	(A)	Voter turnout measures citizen participation, calculated as the proportion of registered voters who actually vote on election day.
Q.23	(A)	In India, poor, rural, and marginalized voters turn out in high numbers because they recognize that voting forces parties to address their livelihood needs.
Q.24	(A)	NOTA allows voters to exercise their democratic right to reject all candidates in a constituency if they find none suitable.
Q.25	(A)	Major challenges in Indian elections include the disproportionate influence of black money, candidates with criminal backgrounds, and dynastic tickets.